



**A LIVE PROJECT REPORT ON
“BRAND VISIBILITY AND DEMAND CREATION STRATEGY FOR A
MID MARKET HANDBAG RETAILER”**

**SUBMITTED BY
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INDUSTRY LIVE PROJECT

**ORGANISATION
RED ONE BAGS**

**SHOP NO. 1, MAYQUEEN APARTMENTS
33RD ROAD, LINKING ROAD
BANDRA WEST, MUMBAI 400050**

PROJECT PERIOD. 10/12/2025 TO 12/1/2025

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my sincere appreciation to the management and staff of Red One Bags for providing the opportunity to work on this project. Their willingness to share operational insights, business challenges, and practical constraints played a significant role in shaping the direction and realism of the analysis.

I am grateful for the cooperation extended during discussions related to branding, sales performance, customer behavior, and store level operations. These interactions helped ensure that the recommendations proposed in this project remained aligned with actual market conditions and business objectives.

This project also provided valuable exposure to real world retail decision making, consumer focused branding, and applied marketing strategy. The learning gained through this experience has contributed meaningfully to my understanding of how analytical thinking and marketing principles translate into practical business outcomes.

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that **Mr. Haji Rayyaan Taj** has successfully completed a Live Project titled **“Brand Visibility and Demand Creation Strategy for a Mid-Market Handbag Retailer”**.

The project was undertaken as an independent professional engagement for an external organisation and involved analysis of brand visibility gaps, customer behaviour, demand creation levers, and practical retail level execution strategies. The work was carried out under real business conditions and operational constraints.

This project is original in nature and was completed independently. It has not been submitted earlier for any academic degree, diploma, or certification, and is not associated with any educational institution or curriculum requirement.

The performance and conduct of Mr. Haji Rayyaan Taj during the course of the project were found to be satisfactory.

For the Organisation

Red One Bags

Branch Head

Name

Designation

Chief Executive Officer

Name

Designation

Date: _____

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ABSTRACT

This live project examines brand visibility and demand creation challenges faced by a mid market handbag retailer operating in a high footfall physical retail environment in Mumbai. The study was undertaken under real business conditions and focused on identifying execution level factors influencing customer engagement, brand recall, and sales performance. While the management initially attributed declining sales to external market pressures such as inflation and rising operating costs, the project sought to assess whether internal branding and demand creation gaps played a more decisive role.

The research adopted a qualitative and exploratory approach based on store level observation, competitor benchmarking, digital content analysis, and customer behaviour mapping. Digitally strong mid market handbag brands were analysed to understand effective visual branding, content strategies, and engagement practices. Primary insights were drawn from in store observations, surrounding retail footfall analysis, and evaluation of customer purchase sequencing in a high traffic shopping zone.

Findings indicate that reduced sales performance is driven largely by weak brand architecture, inconsistent branding execution, ineffective brand mark placement, and limited visual differentiation rather than market conditions alone. The study also identified underutilised demand potential from nearby Gen Z consumers and young working women, whose purchase behaviour is strongly influenced by aesthetics, social validation, and visual presentation. Gaps in social media communication, content relevance, and customer engagement further constrained demand creation.

Based on the analysis, the project proposes practical, low budget, execution focused strategies aimed at improving brand visibility, strengthening demand creation, and aligning store level engagement with actual customer behaviour. The study concludes that focused improvements in internal execution, branding consistency, and audience aligned communication provide a more controllable and sustainable path to sales improvement than reliance on external market explanations

INTRODUCTION

The retail fashion accessories sector has undergone steady shifts in recent years, shaped by rising competition, evolving consumer preferences, and the growing role of digital platforms in influencing purchase decisions. Handbags are no longer viewed only as functional items. They are now treated as style oriented accessories where design, brand perception, and social visibility strongly affect consumer choice. Within this context, mid market handbag retailers operate under constant pressure to differentiate themselves while managing cost limitations and competing with multiple nearby stores.

For physical retail businesses, brand visibility and demand creation directly affect store walk ins, customer engagement, and overall sales outcomes. When branding lacks consistency or positioning remains unclear, customer recall weakens. This often leads to lower store visibility and reduced purchase intent, even when product quality and pricing remain competitive. These challenges become sharper when the target audience includes Gen Z consumers and young working women, groups who place strong importance on visual presentation, peer influence, and brand identity during the buying process.

This live project examines the brand visibility gaps and demand creation challenges faced by a mid market handbag retailer located in a high footfall retail area. The study reviews current branding practices, observed customer behavior, and both in store and digital touchpoints that shape purchase decisions. The analysis relies on direct observation, customer interaction mapping, and content focused demand creation efforts rather than abstract frameworks or assumptions.

The objective of this report is to provide a structured evaluation of the retailer's existing branding and sales environment and to outline practical strategies aimed at improving visibility, strengthening customer recall, and supporting sustained demand. The insights and recommendations presented are grounded in real operational conditions and are intended to assist informed decision making at the execution level.

INDUSTRY BACKGROUND

The Indian fashion accessories market has expanded steadily over the past decade, supported by rising urbanization, increased participation of women in education and the workforce, and higher exposure to fashion trends through digital platforms. Handbags form a core category within this market and are no longer viewed only as functional carry items. They are positioned as lifestyle products linked to personal style, social identity, and situational usage such as office, college, travel, and social occasions.

The mid market handbag segment occupies a distinct position between unbranded low cost products and premium branded offerings. Retailers in this segment compete on a combination of design appeal, affordability, perceived quality, and immediate availability. Customers in this category expect products to look fashionable and contemporary while remaining within accessible price ranges. As a result, differentiation through branding, visual merchandising, and communication has become as important as product assortment.

Physical retail locations in high footfall areas such as linking roads and shopping streets continue to play a major role in handbag purchases. Many buying decisions are impulse driven or occur as part of outfit completion rather than planned shopping. Customers often purchase handbags after selecting clothing or footwear, making visibility, store presentation, and ease of engagement critical success factors for retailers operating in such environments.

Digital platforms, particularly social media, have significantly influenced how customers discover and evaluate handbag brands. Visual content, reels, influencer exposure, and peer validation affect perception even for offline purchases. Younger consumer segments, especially Gen Z and early career working women, show strong sensitivity to aesthetics, color, design uniqueness, and social relevance. Retailers that fail to adapt their branding and communication to these expectations risk losing relevance despite competitive pricing.

Within this industry context, mid-market handbag retailers face increasing pressure to maintain consistent brand identity, communicate value clearly, and align in store experience with evolving consumer behavior. Effective demand creation now requires coordination between physical retail presence, visual branding, and content led engagement rather than reliance on location or price alone.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

The brand initially communicated a decline in sales performance and attributed this downturn primarily to adverse market conditions, rising operating costs due to inflation, and increasing financial pressure. From the management's perspective, these external factors were viewed as the main reasons for reduced revenue and constrained business growth. The brand also expressed the need for solutions to increase sales and improve overall market positioning.

However, during the course of the project, it became evident that the challenges faced by the business extended beyond external market conditions. Limited brand visibility, inconsistent branding practices, weak customer recall, and lack of clear differentiation were observed as internal factors affecting demand creation and store level performance. These issues reduced the effectiveness of the retailer's presence in a competitive and high footfall retail environment.

Another significant constraint during the project was minimal and irregular communication from the brand after the initial briefing. Follow up interactions were delayed or did not take place despite repeated attempts to seek clarification and feedback. As a result, the analysis and recommendations presented in this report are largely based on initial discussions, on site observations, independent market assessment, and consumer behavior insights, rather than continuous managerial input.

This problem statement therefore addresses two core challenges. The first relates to identifying and diagnosing the underlying causes of declining sales beyond external economic factors. The second relates to developing practical and implementable strategies in a low engagement context, where access to real time operational data and ongoing managerial feedback was limited. The project aims to respond to these constraints by focusing on observable gaps in branding, visibility, and demand creation that can be addressed at the retail execution level.

OBJECTIVE OF THE RESEARCH

The primary objective of this research is to examine the factors affecting brand visibility and demand creation for a mid-market handbag retailer operating in a competitive physical retail environment. The study seeks to move beyond externally cited reasons for declining sales and identify internal branding and execution related gaps influencing customer engagement and purchase behaviour.

The specific objectives of the research are as follows.

1. To assess the existing brand visibility of the retailer across in store, product level, and digital touchpoints.
2. To understand customer behaviour patterns, purchase triggers, and decision-making factors relevant to handbags within the mid-market segment.
3. To identify gaps in branding consistency, product presentation, and communication that limit customer recall and perceived value.
4. To evaluate how younger consumer segments, particularly Gen Z and young working women, respond to design, aesthetics, pricing, and visual appeal in handbag purchases.
5. To analyse the effectiveness of current demand creation efforts and identify areas where content, visual merchandising, and engagement strategies fall short.
6. To propose practical and actionable recommendations aimed at improving brand visibility, strengthening demand creation, and supporting sales growth under real operational constraints.

METHODOLOGY

The methodology adopted for this live project was qualitative and exploratory in nature, focused on practical benchmarking, observation, and applied market analysis rather than primary survey based research. The approach was selected due to limited ongoing interaction with the brand after the initial briefing and the objective of improving brand visibility through actionable execution.

A comparative brand benchmarking approach was used, with specific focus on digitally strong mid market handbag brands such as Lino Perros, Miraggio, and Pinaken. These brands were selected because they operate within a similar price segment and have built strong visibility and recall through Instagram led brand building. Their content strategy, visual identity, product presentation, use of models, reel formats, tone of communication, and consistency across posts were closely observed and documented.

Secondary data was collected through analysis of publicly available digital content, including Instagram feeds, reels, highlights, captions, and engagement patterns of the selected benchmark brands. Attention was given to visual aesthetics, color usage, storytelling formats, influencer presence, and call to action techniques used to drive engagement and demand.

Primary insights were gathered through on site observation of the retail environment and informal interaction patterns within the store location. Customer behavior, product visibility, branding placement, and staff engagement approach were observed to understand gaps between offline presence and digital expectations shaped by online brands.

In addition, customer behavior insights were derived through observation of surrounding retail footfall and purchase sequencing in a high traffic shopping area. This helped in understanding how handbags function as an outfit completion purchase rather than a primary shopping intent.

The analysis and recommendations presented in this report are based on the synthesis of competitor benchmarking, digital content analysis, retail observation, and consumer behavior patterns. The methodology prioritizes practicality and feasibility under real world constraints rather than controlled academic experimentation.

ANALYSIS AND FINDINGS

This section presents a consolidated analysis of the observations, assessments, and insights derived during the course of the live project. Due to limited and irregular communication from the management after the initial briefing, the analysis was structured around four core areas that were both accessible for evaluation and critical to understanding the brand's current performance. These areas include branding, issues highlighted by the owner, social media presence, and independent ideas developed through observation and benchmarking.

The analysis is primarily qualitative in nature and is based on direct store level observation, product inspection, review of existing brand communication, and comparative evaluation with digitally active competitors in the same market segment. Rather than relying on internal performance data or continuous managerial inputs, the findings focus on visible execution gaps, customer facing touchpoints, and market level realities that influence brand visibility and demand creation.

Each section addresses a specific dimension of the business. The branding section examines identity clarity, brand architecture, product level branding, and internal consistency. The section on problems stated by the owner contrasts management perceptions with observable market behavior and execution level issues. The social media section evaluates the brand's digital presence in relation to target audience expectations and competitor practices. The ideas section consolidates actionable strategies derived from customer behavior patterns, location based insights, and content driven demand creation methods.

Together, these four sections provide a structured and realistic assessment of why the brand is experiencing visibility and demand challenges despite operating in a high footfall location. The findings aim to separate external assumptions from internal execution gaps and to establish a clear foundation for practical recommendations. This approach ensures that the analysis remains grounded in real world constraints while still offering direction for measurable improvement.

SECTION 1. BRANDING

The branding analysis relied on direct store observation, close inspection of products, and a review of existing brand assets recorded during project execution. Limited follow up from management restricted access to formal brand guidelines or stated strategic intent. The assessment therefore focused on visible brand execution, consistency across touchpoints, and coherence in presentation rather than documented positioning statements.

A key finding relates to the absence of a clearly defined and communicated brand architecture. Red One Bags and Red One Jewellery operate as separate Product categories with distinct logos, yet the connection between these categories under a shared parent identity appears weak and uneven. The presence of different logos does not create an issue by itself. The problem arises from the lack of a unifying visual system, shared design language, or common brand cues. This reduces overall recall and weakens coherence across the retail experience.

Customer interaction with different Red One product does not consistently signal membership within a single brand family. This gap restricts cross category recognition and limits cumulative brand equity. In a physical retail setting, where decisions rely on quick visual association, such fragmentation directly affects trust formation and memory recall.

At the product level, a major branding weakness appears in the placement of the brand mark on handbags. The embossing sits at the bottom of the bag, an area rarely visible during normal use. As a result, external observers rarely notice or retain the brand name, which reduces organic visibility and limits word of mouth exposure. Placement at the base also increases surface contact and friction, leading to faster wear. This affects both durability perception and overall quality cues.



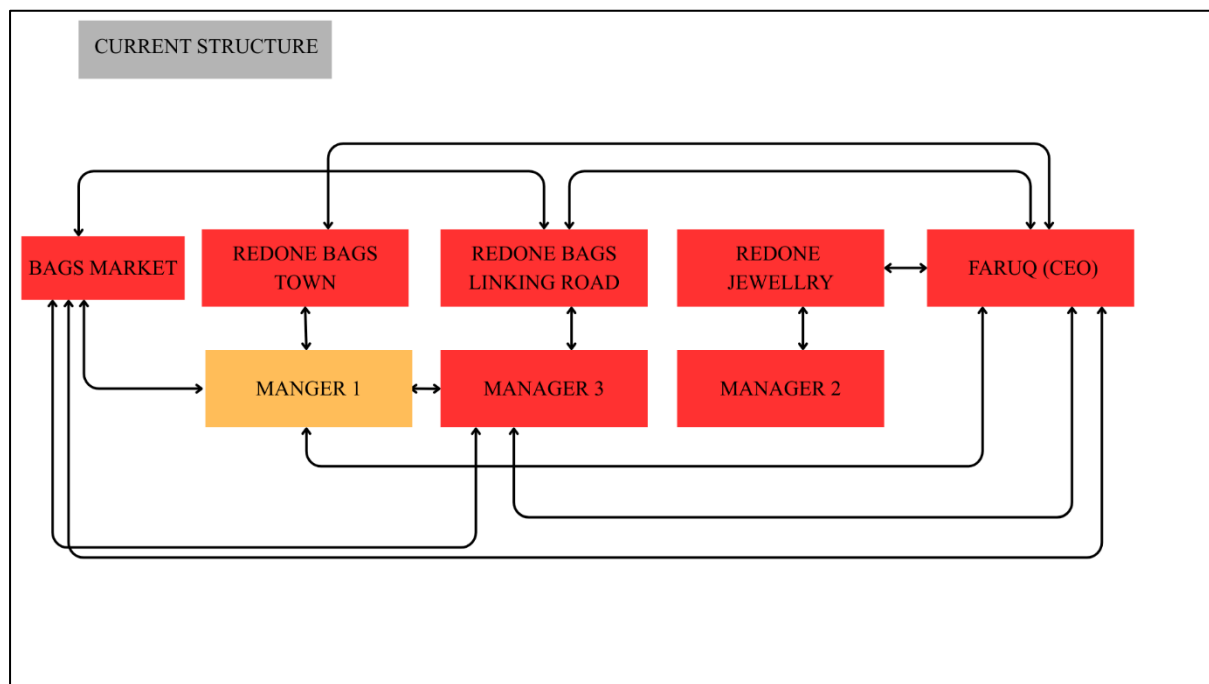
Another issue relates to the absence of strong and repeatable visual identifiers across the handbag range. The assortment lacks a consistent color palette, signature detailing, or recognizable design elements that function as brand cues. Competing mid-market brands often rely on such recurring visuals to build recognition even before logo awareness develops.

Internal execution further amplifies inconsistency. Different outlets and product categories appear to function with relative autonomy. This leads to variation in display standards, communication tone, and resource allocation. Without a central branding framework, brand expression becomes uneven across stores and product lines.

Overall, the analysis shows that reduced visibility does not stem only from external market pressure. The core challenges arise from unclear brand architecture, ineffective brand mark placement, limited visual differentiation, and fragmented internal execution. Closing these gaps forms a necessary foundation before improvements in demand creation and sales outcomes become achievable.

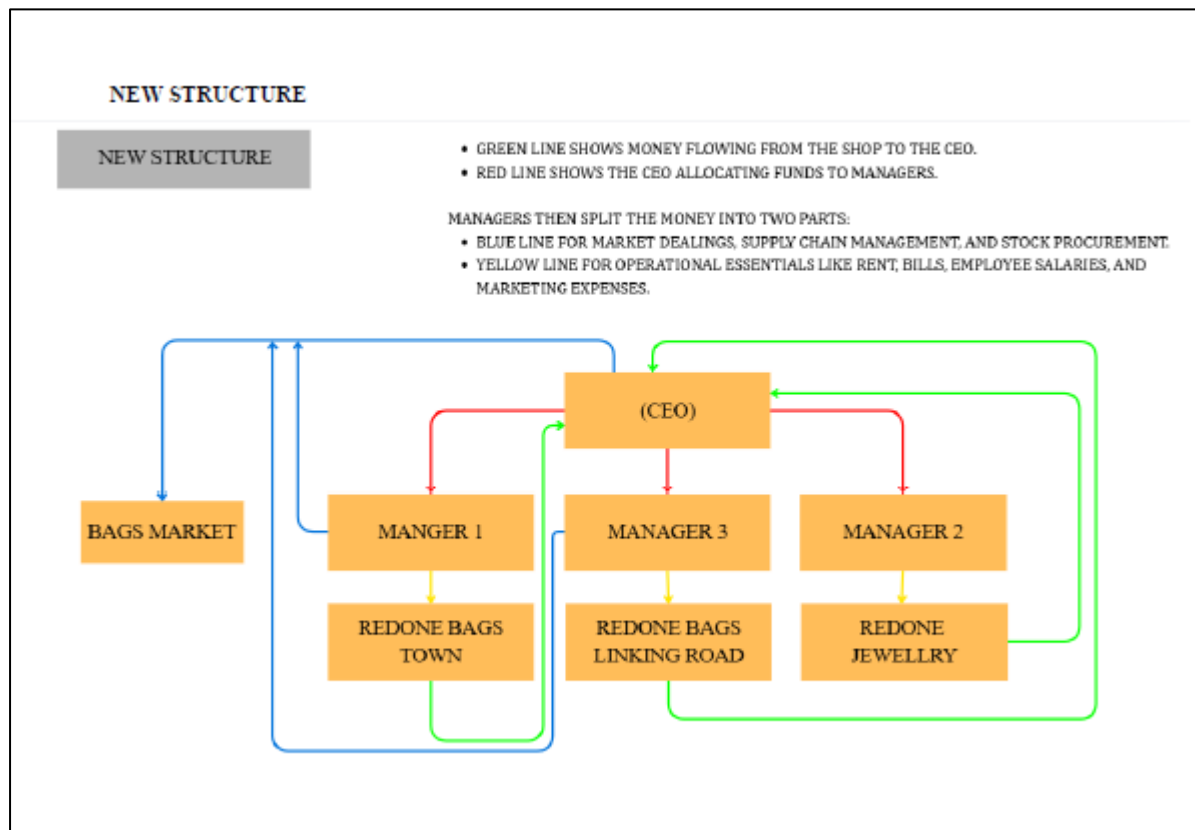
INTERNAL BRANDING STRUCTURE AND EXECUTION FLOW

An additional branding related finding emerged from the review of the internal operational structure of the organisation. The earlier structure shows multiple branches and product categories operating with overlapping reporting lines and informal financial flows. Decision making, budget allocation, and execution responsibilities were not clearly segregated, resulting in inconsistent branding priorities across locations and categories.



Under the earlier structure, branding and marketing related decisions were handled at the branch or manager level without a standardized framework. This led to variation in store presentation, product emphasis, and promotional focus across Red One Bags Town, Red One Bags Linking Road, and Red One Jewellery. As a result, brand execution differed by location rather than reflecting a unified brand direction.

To address this gap, a revised internal structure was proposed with the objective of strengthening control, accountability, and branding consistency. The new structure introduces a clear and centralized flow of authority and finances. Revenue flows from individual shops to the CEO, ensuring centralized visibility and control. Funds are then allocated by the CEO to managers, creating a defined hierarchy and reducing ad hoc decision making.



Under the revised model, managers are responsible for execution within a clearly defined scope. Financial allocation is split into two distinct streams. One stream focuses on market dealings, supply chain management, and stock procurement, while the other stream covers operational essentials such as rent, employee salaries, utilities, and marketing expenses. This separation ensures that branding and marketing budgets are not diluted by operational pressures.

From a branding perspective, this structure supports consistency in three ways. First, centralized control enables alignment on brand identity, tone, and visual standards across all product categories. Second, defined budget allocation allows branding and marketing activities to be planned rather than reactive. Third, clearer accountability ensures that brand execution at the store level reflects the intended positioning rather than individual manager preferences.

The revised internal branding structure therefore directly addresses the execution level fragmentation observed during the analysis. By aligning financial flow, decision authority, and operational responsibility under a single framework, the organisation is better positioned to implement consistent branding, improve visibility, and support coordinated demand creation efforts across locations and product lines.

SECTION 2. PROBLEMS IDENTIFIED BY THE OWNER

At the outset of the project, the management highlighted a set of concerns which they believed were primarily responsible for the business slowdown. These included declining sales attributed to unfavorable market conditions, increasing operating costs due to inflation, a high debt burden, and the need for solutions to improve sales performance and overall market positioning. From the owner's perspective, external economic pressure and cost escalation were seen as the dominant constraints affecting business growth.

While these concerns reflect genuine financial stress faced by many mid market retailers, the analysis indicates that attributing declining sales solely to market conditions presents an incomplete diagnosis. The current retail environment offers customers a wide range of alternatives, both offline and online, allowing easy comparison of price, design, quality, and brand perception. In such a context, businesses that fail to communicate clear value and differentiation are more vulnerable, regardless of broader market conditions.

Observations suggest that the decline in sales is strongly linked to a lack of perceived uniqueness and insufficient value communication at the product and brand level. The handbags do not consistently present a compelling reason for customers to choose them over competing options available in nearby stores or through online brands. This gap limits spontaneous purchase behavior and weakens conversion even when footfall remains strong.

1. To address this issue, the AIDA framework was identified as a relevant and practical model for improving customer engagement and driving sales. The first stage, attention, focuses on increasing visibility through trend based entry points and time bound promotions. Examples include aligning product displays or limited offers with ongoing fashion or cultural trends, as well as using seasonal sales such as festive collections to draw customers into the store. These activities aim to increase store noticeability and initial interest without heavy budget dependence.

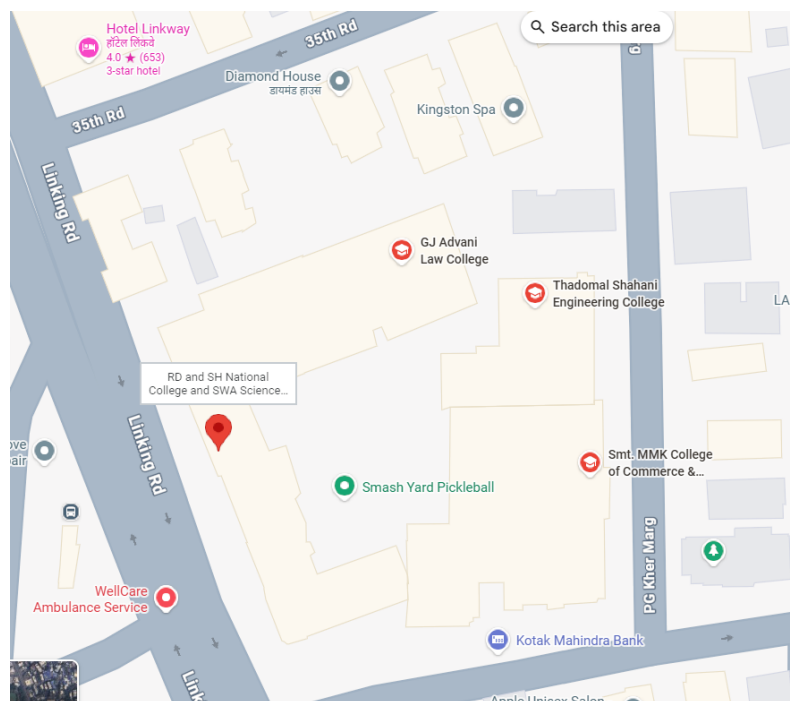
2. The second stage, interest, emphasizes creating visual and design level differentiation. Introducing unique design elements and consistent color schemes within Red One branded bags was identified as a way to generate curiosity and brand association. Limited edition color themes, particularly those aligned with the brand's identity, can serve as a visual cue and create a sense of exclusivity, encouraging customers to explore products more closely.

Example of visual and design are as follow:



3. The third stage, desire, focuses on strengthening emotional appeal and urgency. Use of models, lifestyle visuals, professional photography, and short form video content helps customers imagine product usage in real life contexts. Limited availability messaging, visible stock counts, and controlled pricing strategies contribute to a sense of scarcity. Reference pricing techniques, where higher prices are shown before discounts, help reinforce perceived value and encourage quicker purchase decisions.
4. The final stage, action, highlights the need for clear and frictionless purchase pathways. Generating anticipation before product launches, releasing new styles at regular intervals, and offering limited access collections can stimulate repeat interest. Operational readiness, including defined ordering channels, prompt communication, and timely delivery, is essential to ensure that increased interest translates into completed transactions and customer satisfaction.

A significant opportunity identified during the analysis relates to Gen Z consumers in the immediate catchment area. Nearby colleges contribute a large and consistent base of potential customers, with an estimated range of minimum thousand female students.



Location map showing proximity of nearby colleges to the store location

The map above highlights the close physical proximity of multiple colleges to the store location, creating a dense concentration of Gen Z consumers within walking distance. This spatial context supports the strategic focus on Gen Z driven demand creation and indicates that declining sales are not caused by lack of potential footfall, but by gaps in branding, product presentation, and engagement.

This segment is highly responsive to aesthetics, design, color, and social validation. Unlike older customers who prioritize functionality, Gen Z buyers are driven by visual appeal and perceived relevance. Current engagement practices do not sufficiently differentiate between these segments, resulting in missed conversion opportunities.

To address this, staff interaction and presentation strategies need adjustment based on customer type. Communication style, product recommendations, and visual emphasis should vary depending on whether the customer is a student, working professional, or older buyer. Treating all customers uniformly reduces the effectiveness of engagement and limits personalization.

Immediate low budget actions were also identified to support demand creation. These include community driven content where customers are featured on social media after purchase, a more energetic tone in reels, and improved visual presentation of products. Current content for bags closely mirrors jewellery content, which reduces relevance. Benchmarking against digitally active handbag brands shows a clear preference for aesthetic visuals led by female models or relatable everyday users rather than highly polished professional shoots alone.

Influencer collaborations on a limited and consistent basis, exclusive in store or online collections, and gradual improvement in visual quality through accessible tools were identified as feasible short term actions. These steps aim to improve perceived professionalism and relevance without requiring large financial investment.

Overall, this section highlights a disconnect between management perception and execution level realities. While external factors contribute to pressure, the primary barriers to sales growth lie in weak differentiation, limited demand creation mechanisms, and underutilization of nearby target segments. Addressing these internal gaps provides a more direct and controllable path to improving sales and brand positioning.

IMMEDIATE LOW BUDGET ACTIONS FOR DEMAND CREATION

Based on the analysis, a set of immediate actions was identified which can be implemented within a constrained budget of approximately ₹10,000. These actions focus on improving brand visibility, customer engagement, and perceived product value without requiring structural changes or long term financial commitment. The emphasis is on quick execution, consistency, and alignment with observed consumer behavior.

The first action area is community driven visibility. Customers who purchase bags should be featured through social media stories and saved highlights as satisfied customers. This form of post purchase visibility builds trust and social proof, particularly among younger consumers who rely on peer validation and real usage cues before making purchase decisions. Featuring actual customers also reinforces authenticity and reduces the gap between brand communication and lived experience.

The second action involves a shift in the tone and energy of short form video content. Existing reels appear static and lack emotional pull. Adopting a more energetic presentation style through movement, expression, and pacing is necessary to match current consumption patterns on platforms such as Instagram. This does not require complex production, but does require deliberate framing and consistency in execution.

A key issue identified is the overlap in content style between Red One Bags and Red One Jewellery. The current presentation approach for bags closely mirrors jewellery content, resulting in a generic and repetitive visual identity. Benchmarking against digitally strong handbag brands shows a clear visual pattern where content is aesthetic focused and led by female representation. To address this, handbag content should follow a distinct visual logic, with the first image or thumbnail designed to create immediate visual impact and category differentiation. Consistent use of brand aligned color cues in the opening frame can improve recall and stop scroll behavior.

Rather than relying exclusively on professional models, the brand can leverage everyday customers and relatable profiles for the majority of content. This approach enhances relatability and helps potential buyers visualize how the bags fit into their own lifestyle and personality.

Low cost in house shoots using available space and basic lighting can achieve this outcome when supported by thoughtful composition.

Influencer collaboration was identified as another feasible low budget action. A recommendation of one collaborative reel per week with local or micro creators offers steady exposure and relevance without excessive cost. Consistency and alignment with the target audience are more critical than follower count at this stage.

Product exclusivity was also identified as a short term lever for demand creation. Introducing select designs that are available only in store or only through online orders can generate urgency and differentiate the offering. Limited access strategies encourage repeat engagement and trial without requiring changes to the entire product assortment.

An illustrative before and after comparison was developed to demonstrate how visual presentation can be significantly improved through low cost enhancements. The comparison highlights that the product itself is not the constraint. Improvements in background control, reduction of visual clutter, balanced lighting, and basic aesthetic refinement substantially increase perceived value. These changes are achievable without professional studio setups and fall well within the proposed budget.



Current in store product capture

IMPROVED AESTHETIC PRESENTATION



Overall, these immediate actions are practical, execution focused, and aligned with the brand's current operational capacity. Implemented together, they directly support attention, interest, and desire creation while laying the groundwork for more structured demand generation efforts.

SECTION 3. SOCIAL MEDIA

Social media plays a central role in shaping brand perception and influencing purchase decisions, especially for fashion accessories targeted at younger and middle income consumers. For this project, Instagram was examined as the primary platform due to its strong visual focus and high usage among Gen Z students and working women. This section analyses existing gaps in content style, communication, and engagement approach, and outlines practical recommendations to align social media activity with the brand's target audience, price positioning, and demand creation objectives.

This section outlines key observations and recommendations related to the brand's social media presence, with a focus on Instagram as the primary platform for engagement and demand creation. The points below are based on the target audience profile, observed content gaps, and platform behavior.

1. language of communication

Reels and short videos should be recorded primarily in Hindi, with optional use of simple Hindi English mix. The core target audience includes middle class working women and Gen Z consumers who are either in college or entering the corporate workforce. English dominant content creates a disconnect, as it signals premium positioning that does not align with the brand's price range. Hindi based communication improves relatability, comfort, and emotional connection, leading to higher engagement and response.

2. use of female representation

Content should consistently feature female models or female co leads. Showing how a bag looks while being used by a woman helps the audience visualize size, style, and fit in real life situations. Male led demonstrations reduce contextual relevance and limit the ability of female customers to relate to the product.

3. **alignment with current social media trends**

The brand should avoid frequent trend hopping and instead selectively integrate relevant cultural or seasonal trends into its existing product offerings. The objective is to remain contextually relevant without diluting brand identity. For example, during festive periods such as Christmas, the brand can highlight festive color palettes through limited visual themes. During the period of this project, the Hindi film Dhurandhar gained popularity, particularly due to the black kurta look associated with Akshay Khanna's character, which became a recognizable cultural trend. This moment can be incorporated in a controlled manner by using the film's trending audio and visual cues. For instance, the brand face can appear wearing a black kurta while showcasing black handbags, positioning the product as a women focused style inspired by the ongoing trend. This approach allows the brand to connect with a current cultural moment while ensuring the product remains the central focus.

4. **community building through customer visibility**

Customers who purchase bags should be featured on stories or saved in highlights as happy customers. This builds trust and social proof by showing real people using the product. Community driven content also signals authenticity and encourages new customers to engage with confidence.

5. **clear and interactive call to actions**

Each reel should include a simple and direct call to action that invites participation. Examples include asking viewers to name their preferred color, choose between use cases such as work, travel, or college, or select between style preferences like classy or trendy. An energetic and conversational tone helps reduce hesitation and increases comment based engagement.

6. **product demonstration for clarity**

Reels should clearly demonstrate what items can fit inside the bag, such as wallets, notebooks, bottles, or laptops. This reduces uncertainty and helps customers assess practicality, especially for office and college related purchases.

7. **style and occasion based positioning**

Content should explain which bags suit specific styles and occasions, such as formal office use, weddings, concerts, casual outings, or daily travel. This helps customers quickly identify relevance and simplifies decision making.

8. **usage context and usability cues**

Reels should mention where and how the bag can be used, highlighting comfort, convenience, and everyday usability. Contextual explanation improves perceived usefulness and strengthens purchase intent.

9. **durability and trust signals**

Content should briefly describe material quality, stitching strength, and long term durability. Adding short customer testimonials further reinforces trust and reduces **perceived risk**.

10. **consistent trust messaging**

Using a recurring trust related phrase or theme helps build brand reliability over time. Repetition of such cues strengthens recall and confidence.

11. **color based discovery formats**

Interactive formats such as a color spin wheel can be used, where each color selection reveals multiple bag options in that shade. This keeps content engaging while showcasing variety without overwhelming the viewer.

12. **Scarcity and impulse cues**

Mentioning limited stock availability creates urgency and encourages faster action. Scarcity cues reduce postponement and increase impulse driven inquiries.

13. **engagement driven reel ideas**

Reel concepts such as tagging someone whose initials match the bag or who should gift the bag increase sharing and reach through peer interaction.

14. **clear product identification**

When multiple bags are shown in a single reel, numbering them helps customers respond easily. This reduces confusion and improves inquiry efficiency.

15. **social proof through visible demand**

Showing high customer interest or multiple purchases creates a bandwagon effect. When viewers see others buying, they are more likely to trust and engage with the brand.

16. **Alignment of reel style with product and user**

The tone, visuals, and music of each reel should match the product type, target user, and usage situation. Office handbags should be shown with professional styling, calm backgrounds, and soft music. College bags should use faster pacing, trend driven music, and casual visuals. Scripts should highlight features relevant to each use case, such as capacity, appearance, comfort, and price.

17. **Content seeding strategy**

Reels should be published simultaneously through multiple mid sized creator accounts to increase visibility and encourage organic replication. This strategy works best when the brand's own products are consistently showcased and supported by daily customer content.

18. **Active community engagement**

The brand should actively engage with posts from other relevant handbag and accessory accounts by leaving meaningful comments. This builds visibility within the niche and positions the account as active and credible.

19. **Algorithm related engagement behavior**

Consistent interaction through likes and comments across the platform strengthens relationship signals. While this does not directly increase reach for individual posts, it improves overall account trust and long term visibility.

Overall, the social media analysis highlights the need for clearer audience alignment, stronger visual relevance, and more interactive content. When executed consistently, these actions position social media as a key driver of brand visibility, trust, and demand creation rather than a passive display channel.

SECTION 4. ADDITIONAL IDEAS PROPOSED: CUSTOMER MAPPING

Customer mapping was proposed as an additional strategic idea to improve sales by aligning store level engagement with actual shopping behavior observed in high footfall areas. Instead of competing directly with other bag stores on Linking Road, Red One Bags can benefit by positioning itself as the final purchase destination in a customer's shopping journey.

Customer Buying Pattern Insight

Women generally follow a sequential shopping pattern. The process typically begins with selecting clothing, followed by footwear, and concludes with choosing a bag to complete the overall look. In this sequence, the bag functions as a finishing element rather than a primary purchase. This insight is critical because it indicates that customers who reach the bag selection stage are already closer to making a buying decision.

Linking Road attracts consistent footfall for western wear, ethnic kurtis, footwear such as kolhapuris, heels, and sneakers, as well as cosmetics and accessories. This environment creates a natural demand flow for handbags, as shoppers seek items that visually complete their outfit rather than replace earlier purchases.

Key Customer Touchpoints

Red One Bags is located at Shop No. 1, Mayqueen Apartments, 33rd Road, a zone surrounded by high traffic retail activity. Nearby touchpoints include clothing stalls selling western tops, dresses, co ord sets, denim, and ethnic wear. Footwear stores offering flats, heels, and sneakers also draw significant female footfall. Cosmetics and accessory vendors selling jewellery, scarves, and beauty products further support outfit completion behavior.

These adjacent stores act as indirect demand generators for Red One Bags, as customers exiting them are already mentally primed for complementary purchases.

Customer Mapping and Engagement Plan

During peak hours, store staff should observe and engage customers based on attire, context, and shopping intent. Formally dressed customers, particularly office goers during weekdays, can be approached with structured handbags positioned for professional use. Customers wearing Indian or desi attire, especially during weekends or festive periods, can be shown embroidered or ethnic style bags that align with their outfit. Casual shoppers, including college students and young adults, can be guided toward slings, backpacks, or trendy designs suited for daily use.

Staff communication should focus on positioning the bag as the final styling element that completes the look the customer has already chosen. This approach reduces selling resistance and aligns the product recommendation with the customer's existing intent.

Overall, customer mapping shifts the sales approach from generic selling to context driven engagement. By understanding where the customer is in their shopping journey and responding accordingly, Red One Bags can improve conversion rates without relying on discounts or aggressive promotion.

SUMMARY OF ANALYSIS AND FINDINGS

The analysis and findings reveal that the challenges faced by the brand are driven more by internal execution gaps than by external market conditions alone. While the management attributed declining sales primarily to inflation, rising costs, and broader market pressure, the study indicates that weak brand clarity, inconsistent execution, and limited demand creation mechanisms are the core constraints affecting performance.

From a branding perspective, the absence of a clearly defined brand architecture has resulted in fragmented brand recall. Although Red One Bags and Red One Jewellery operate as separate product categories with different logos, the lack of a shared visual system and unified brand cues weakens overall brand coherence. This fragmentation is further reinforced by ineffective brand mark placement on handbags and the absence of strong, repeatable visual identifiers such as consistent color palettes or signature design elements. In a high footfall physical retail environment, these gaps directly reduce visibility, recall, and trust.

Internal operational structure was identified as a contributing factor to inconsistent brand execution. Decentralized decision making, overlapping responsibilities, and informal financial flows led to variation in branding priorities across outlets. The proposed revised structure, with centralized financial control and clearer role segregation, directly addresses these issues by enabling consistency, accountability, and planned branding investment.

The assessment of management stated problems highlighted a mismatch between perceived causes and actual drivers of low sales. Customers today have multiple alternatives and make rapid comparisons. The lack of differentiation and weak value communication at the product and presentation level limit conversion, even when footfall is available. Application of the AIDA framework demonstrated that improvements are required across attention, interest, desire, and action stages to rebuild demand systematically.

A significant opportunity exists within the immediate catchment area due to the concentration of Gen Z consumers from nearby colleges. The location analysis confirmed that potential demand is present, but current engagement strategies do not align with the preferences of this segment, which prioritizes aesthetics, social validation, and visual appeal. Uniform customer handling further reduces effectiveness.

The analysis also identified several immediate, low budget actions that can improve visibility and perceived value without structural changes. These include community driven content, stronger visual presentation, differentiated content for bags versus jewellery, use of relatable models, selective influencer collaboration, and limited product exclusivity. Visual comparisons confirmed that perceived product value can be significantly enhanced through low cost aesthetic improvements.

Overall, the findings indicate that improving brand clarity, visual differentiation, internal alignment, and audience specific engagement offers a more direct and controllable path to improving sales and positioning than reliance on external market explanations.

CONCLUSION

This live project examined the brand visibility and demand creation challenges faced by a mid market handbag retailer operating in a high footfall retail environment. The study moved beyond externally stated reasons for declining sales and focused on observable execution level gaps affecting customer recall, engagement, and conversion.

The analysis demonstrated that reduced sales performance is not primarily the result of unfavorable market conditions, but rather a consequence of weak brand clarity, inconsistent branding execution, limited visual differentiation, and underdeveloped demand creation mechanisms. Fragmented brand architecture, ineffective placement of brand identifiers, and lack of repeatable visual cues have collectively weakened brand recall and trust, particularly in a competitive physical retail setting where purchase decisions are fast and visually driven.

Operational review further highlighted that decentralized decision making and unclear financial flows contributed to inconsistent branding and marketing priorities across outlets. The proposed internal structural alignment offers a foundation for improving accountability, budget discipline, and consistency in brand execution.

Customer behavior analysis revealed a strong opportunity within the immediate catchment area, especially among Gen Z students and young working women. The proximity of multiple colleges confirms that potential demand exists, but current engagement practices do not align with the aesthetic, social, and visual preferences of this segment. Treating all customers uniformly limits personalization and reduces conversion potential.

The project also established that meaningful improvements in visibility and perceived value can be achieved through low budget, execution focused actions. Community driven content, refined visual presentation, differentiated content strategies for handbags, selective influencer collaboration, and context based customer engagement offer practical and realistic levers for demand creation without significant financial investment.

Overall, the findings reinforce that sustainable improvement in sales and positioning depends on strengthening internal execution, clarifying brand identity, and aligning engagement strategies with actual customer behavior. By addressing these controllable internal factors, the brand is better positioned to improve visibility, rebuild demand, and compete effectively within the mid market handbag segment.

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